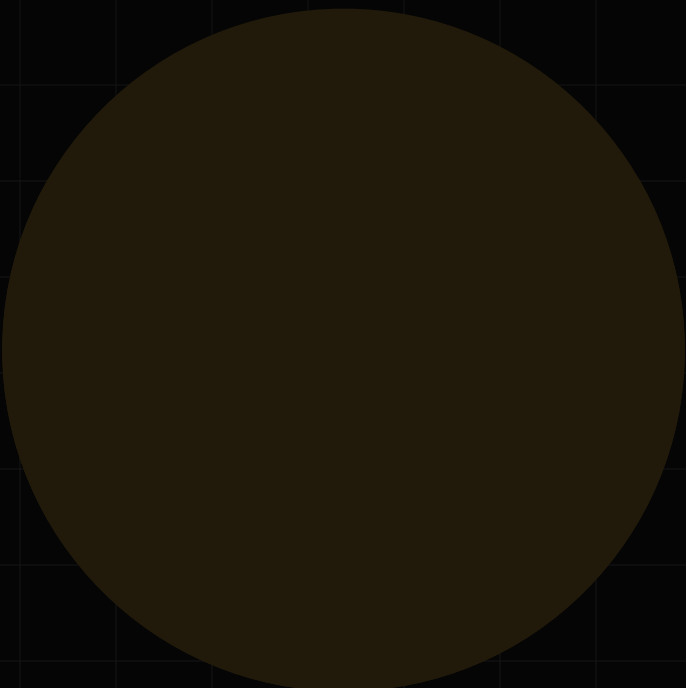


COMMANDS OF JESUS

Baptism

A teaching framework for repentance, public obedience, and new life in Christ.



Core idea: baptism publicly declares that the old life is gone and the believer belongs to Jesus.

TEACHING 01

The Command to Be Baptized

KEY SCRIPTURES

- Acts 2:38 *"Repent and be baptized, every one of you..."*
- Matthew 28:19 *"Go therefore and make disciples... baptizing them..."*
- Mark 16:16 *"Whoever believes and is baptized will be saved..."*

KEY IDEA

- Baptism is not optional for the believer.
- It is a command from Jesus.
- It is the first public act of obedience after repentance and faith.

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

1. **Why did Jesus include baptism in the Great Commission?**
2. **What does it communicate when someone delays baptism?**
3. **Is baptism a suggestion or a command?**

TEACHING 02

What Baptism Represents

KEY SCRIPTURES

- Romans 6:3-4 *"We were buried with Him through baptism into death... that we too may live a new life."*
- Colossians 2:12 *"Buried with Him in baptism and raised with Him through faith."*
- 2 Corinthians 5:17 *"If anyone is in Christ, he is a new creation..."*

KEY IDEA

- Baptism is an outward declaration of an inward transformation. It represents death to the old life, burial of sin, and resurrection into new life.
- The water does not save you. Jesus saves you.
- Baptism publicly declares that your old life is gone and you belong to Him.

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

1. **What does it mean that your old self has been buried?**
2. **Are there parts of your old life you are still holding onto?**
3. **Why does Jesus want this declaration to be public?**

TEACHING 03

Repentance and Baptism Go Together

KEY SCRIPTURES

- Acts 2:41 *"Those who accepted his message were baptized..."*
- Acts 8:12 *"When they believed... they were baptized..."*
- Acts 22:16 *"What are you waiting for? Get up, be baptized..."*

KEY IDEA

- In the New Testament pattern:
 - People heard the Gospel.
 - They repented.
 - They believed.
 - They were baptized.
 - There was no long delay.
 - There was immediate obedience.

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

1. **What are common reasons people delay baptism today?**
2. **Are those reasons found in Scripture?**
3. **If you have repented and believed, what is stopping you?**

TEACHING 04

Baptism Is for Believers

KEY SCRIPTURES

- Acts 16:31-33 *"Believe in the Lord Jesus... then immediately he was baptized."*
- Acts 18:8 *"Many who heard believed and were baptized."*

KEY IDEA

- Belief precedes baptism.

- Baptism follows personal repentance and faith.
- It is not based on age. It is based on belief.
- If a child understands the Gospel and repents, they can be baptized.
- If an adult comes to faith later in life, they should be baptized.
- Obedience is not limited by age.

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

1. **Do you believe baptism should follow personal faith?**
2. **How do we discern if someone is ready for baptism?**
3. **Have you personally repented and believed?**

TEACHING 05

Why Age Does Not Disqualify

KEY SCRIPTURES

- *Acts 10:47-48 "Can anyone keep these people from being baptized?"*
- *Galatians 3:27 "All of you who were baptized into Christ have clothed yourselves with Christ."*

KEY IDEA

- Baptism is about obedience to Jesus, not stage of life.
- The early church baptized new believers immediately.
- There was no spiritual retirement age.
- There was no minimum prestige level.
- If you have been transformed inwardly, you are called to declare it outwardly.

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

1. **If God has changed you, why hide it?**
2. **What would it look like to boldly declare your faith publicly?**
3. **Is fear keeping you from obedience?**

TEACHING 06

What Baptism Is Not

- Baptism is not a family tradition.
- Baptism is not a cultural ritual.
- Baptism is not a church membership requirement.

- Baptism is not a replacement for repentance.
- It does not save you. It follows salvation. It confirms allegiance to Jesus as Lord.

TEACHING 07

Heart Check

KEY SCRIPTURES

- *Luke 9:26 "Whoever is ashamed of Me..."*
- *John 14:15 "If you love Me, keep My commands."*

REFLECTION QUESTIONS

1. **Have I repented and trusted Jesus?**
2. **Have I been baptized as a believer?**
3. **If not, why am I waiting?**
4. **Is fear, pride, or misunderstanding holding me back?**

TEACHING 08

Practical Baptism Plan

- Have I truly repented and believed?
- If yes, schedule baptism soon.
- Invite family and friends to witness your declaration.
- Share your testimony publicly.
- Walk forward in new life.

PERSONAL ACTION QUESTIONS

1. **When did I give my life to Jesus?**
2. **Was I baptized after that decision?**
3. **If not, when will I obey?**
4. **Who will I invite to witness this step?**

TEACHING 09

Closing Prayer Prompt

PRAYER PROMPT

Lord Jesus, thank You for saving me. Thank You for making me new. Give me courage to obey You fully. If I have delayed baptism, help me take this step in faith. Let my life boldly declare that I belong to You. Amen.